

Praveen Kothapally

Technology Governance & Transformation Leader

AI Governance · Technology Risk · Delivery Excellence · Regulatory Readiness

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Professional Summary

Technology Governance & Transformation Leader with 22+ years across banking, financial services, and insurance. Expertise connecting technology delivery with ISO 27001, ICIF, PCI, third-party risk, evidence management, audit response, and remediation tracking. Hands-on AI practitioner building production-ready GRC prototypes. Certified PMP, SAFe 6 Agilist, AWS Cloud Practitioner, and Scrum Master.

Core Competencies: ISO 27001 · Technology Risk · Audit & Compliance · GRC · Regulatory Readiness · Third-Party Risk · Evidence Management · AI Governance

Professional Experience

Traveler Insurance Services — Zurich Insurance Group / Cover-More Group

Program Manager — Technology Delivery, Governance and Compliance

Dec 2023 – Present · Remote, MN

- › Coordinate delivery across engineering, QA, business analysis, infrastructure, operations, and business stakeholders.
- › Support ISO 27001, internal-control, PCI, and third-party risk initiatives through evidence coordination, ownership tracking, and audit response.
- › Improve cross-functional delivery governance, accountability, and executive visibility.
- › Explore AI-enabled approaches to governance documentation, evidence management, and delivery operations.
- › Spearheaded Third-Party Risk Management (TPRM) process implementation with cross-functional stakeholders.
- › Lead release governance across planning, readiness, deployment coordination, production validation, and closure.
- › Coach multiple delivery teams in planning, dependency management, continuous improvement, and predictable execution.
- › Manage sanction screening governance including rollout support, production monitoring, and file cadence oversight.
- › Develop release runbooks, deployment plans, validation standards, release calendars, and leadership communications.
- › Built and maintain centralized evidence repositories in Confluence and SharePoint, improving audit response efficiency.
- › Develop control traceability across RACE, Zurich control frameworks, and internal implementation activities.
- › Coordinate evidence collection, action-item follow-up, and meeting preparation for audit, risk, and compliance

reviews.

- › Received the Care and Collaboration Award for outstanding contributions in audit and compliance improvements.

Bank of the West — BNP Paribas

Vice President — Technology Manager / Scrum Master

Oct 2018 – Dec 2023 · Omaha, NE

- › Led enterprise technology upgrade and transformation programs across retail banking operations.
- › Managed global teams, vendors, software delivery risk, and cross-functional execution.
- › Delivered ~20% delivery productivity improvement through Agile transformation and process redesign.
- › Reduced manual testing ~70% through automation engineering and DevOps practices.
- › Delivered documented savings exceeding \$250K through automation and operating-model improvements.
- › Created project delivery and maturity roadmaps across UI, API, and database layers aligned with strategic objectives.
- › Established quality, release, and delivery controls for critical banking platforms.
- › Led globally co-located teams to execute short-term and long-term projects, fostering innovation and high performance.
- › Spearheaded seamless delivery of multi-million-dollar technology upgrades across all branches as trusted SME.

Bank of the West — BNP Paribas

Associate Vice President — Senior Lead Quality Assurance

Dec 2017 – Oct 2018 · Omaha, NE

- › Led 15-member geographically distributed QA team supporting critical core banking initiatives.
- › Developed CI/CD-based automation frameworks for cross-browser, API, and mainframe legacy applications.
- › Delivered zero-defect releases saving \$200,000; designed automation solutions saving 200+ hours.
- › Promoted BDD and TDD best practices across delivery teams.
- › Used Agile practices: Daily Stand-ups, Sprint Planning, Prioritized backlogs, Retrospectives, and MVPs.

Bank of the West — BNP Paribas

Senior QA Consultant — Global Banking CRM

Dec 2015 – Dec 2017 · San Ramon, CA

- › Served as Scrum Master and Senior QA Consultant on core banking and CRM transformation projects.
- › Single-handedly designed and managed critical automation initiative contributing to zero-defect releases with \$250,000 in savings.
- › Used PL/SQL, HP UFT, HP ALM, Jira, Confluence, and Xray to strengthen quality engineering.
- › Led Scrum Ceremonies and maintained delivery velocity for the projects.

Apple · American Express · First Tech FCU · Infosys · Accenture

Technology Leadership — Quality Engineering & Program Management

2002 – 2018 · Various, US & India

- › Implemented scalable test automation and delivery-governance practices across CRM, banking, data, and

enterprise applications.

- › Led distributed technology and quality teams across onsite and offshore delivery models.
- › Progressed through quality engineering, automation, consulting, test management, and process-transformation roles.
- › Delivered zero-defect releases for core banking applications saving \$200,000+ per engagement.
- › Built QA gating processes and implemented Agile methodologies across sales CRM at Apple.
- › Established fast-paced Agile processes and streamlined testing workflows at American Express.
- › Implemented Kanban approach in leading enterprise-solutions team at First Tech Federal Credit Union.

AI & Innovation Initiatives

AssureCore

AI Governance, Risk & Compliance Platform · 35+ Frameworks

A deployed, working platform built by a practitioner who coordinates these audit programs daily. Includes specialist AI-assisted workflows for compliance documentation, control mapping, and evidence management.

UnderwriterAI

AI · Insurance · Multi-Agent Prototype

Bridges domain expertise in insurance delivery with applied AI product thinking. Demonstrates initiative at the intersection of operations, AI, and governance.

AgentVerse

AI · Governance Automation · Orchestration Framework

AI applied to the exact governance and delivery workflows I manage daily — demonstrates practical automation thinking grounded in real operational experience.

Delivery & Quality Tools

QA · Jira Governance · Delivery Tooling

Tooling that directly supports release governance and QA maturity — the same problems these tools solve are ones I address for organizations every day.

Governance & Compliance Expertise

My differentiator is the ability to work across both delivery and governance — embedding ownership, evidence, and repeatable controls into day-to-day technology operations.

- › ISO 27001 audit readiness and coordination
- › Internal technology controls and ICIF control coordination
- › PCI assessment support
- › Evidence management and centralized repositories
- › Control ownership and traceability
- › Risk identification and remediation tracking
- › Third-party technology risk governance (TPRM)

Technical Skills

GOVERNANCE & RISK

COMPLIANCE & AUDIT

DELIVERY LEADERSHIP

Technology Governance · Technology Risk · Operational Resilience · Executive Reporting · Decision Controls

ISO 27001 · ICIF · PCI · Third-Party Risk · Control Evidence · Audit Response

Program Management · Release Governance · Stakeholder Management · Vendor Management · Portfolio Coordination

AGILE & QUALITY

Scrum · Kanban · SAFe · Quality Engineering · Automation · Continuous Improvement

TECHNOLOGY & AI

Jira · Confluence · AWS · Python · TypeScript · AI Governance · SharePoint · CI/CD

Education

Bangalore University — B.E., Electrical & Electronics Engineering (1998–2001)

Certifications

- › **PMP®** — Project Management Institute (2021)
- › **SAFe® 6 Agilist** — Scaled Agile (2023)
- › **AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner** — Amazon Web Services (2024)
- › **Scrum Master Accredited Certification** — International Scrum Institute (2020)
- › **AZ-400 Designing and Implementing Microsoft DevOps Solutions** — Microsoft